command line to add such a directory. Note that this goes in your project folder, since it is a sibling of your home app directory; it does *not* go in the RiffMates/RiffMates configuration folder. The following listing shows the complete folder structure so far.

Listing 3.7 The new templates directory and the soon-to-be-created news.html

```
RiffMates/
├── RiffMates
│   ├── __init__.py
│   ├── asgi.py
│   ├── settings.py
│   ├── urls.py
│   └── wsgi.py
├── home
│   ├── __init__.py
│   ├── admin.py
│   ├── apps.py
│   ├── models.py
│   ├── tests.py
│   └── views.py
├── manage.py
└── templates
    └── news.html
```

Template locations: A common location vs. app directories

The `APP_DIRS` option in the `TEMPLATES` configuration allows you to tell Django to look inside your apps for templates. When `APP_DIRS` is `True`, Django will look for a directory named templates in each of your app directories. Whether you keep all of your templates with their corresponding apps or put them in a common location is a matter of style.

When I first started writing Django, I tended to keep my templates with their corresponding apps. I only used the common folder for reusable template blocks. Over time, I have drifted in the other direction. For most projects I have found it simpler to keep all the HTML in one place.

The one exception is if the app itself is reusable. Reusable apps are beyond the scope of this book, but you can write Django apps that can be installed like other Python projects. In this case, any templates the app needs must be shipped with the app and, thus, go in the app's templates directory.

The `DIRS` property list expects a fully qualified path to your template directory. Paths like this are common in the settings.py file. As most paths in your project will be relative to the project directory, Django declares a configuration option near the top of settings.py, called `BASE_DIR`. By default, the value of `BASE_DIR` is the fully qualified path of your project directory inside a `pathlib.Path` object. Older versions of Django